

TEMPLATE REPO

AI Design Harness

Check you're building the right thing, then design it the way your team would — with AI agents like Claude Code or Codex.

github.com/sadakoai/ai-design-harness

WHY

Why it exists

What we know about users and our design rules usually live in people's heads. The harness writes both down as small files, plus five skills (saved instructions like /frame) and a check script, so an AI agent can follow them.

Today

- ✗ PRDs aren't checked against what we know
- ✗ One long doc mixes rules and one-off calls
- ✗ Review comments are opinions, not rules
- ✗ Lessons get lost in old chat threads

With the harness

- ✓ Each PRD is checked against users and jobs
- ✓ One question, one file
- ✓ Findings cite a rule, or say it's taste
- ✓ Lessons flow back into product and design

WHAT YOU GET

One proposal per screen or flow

A framing first, then about three clickable mockups, a recommendation and a spec on one HTML page, reviewed against your rules. Your team still decides, and builds it.

Support

MT Mia Torres

Inbox

10 open requests. 2 high-priority requests have no assignee.

Open10

Unassigned5

Assigned to me2

Done today3

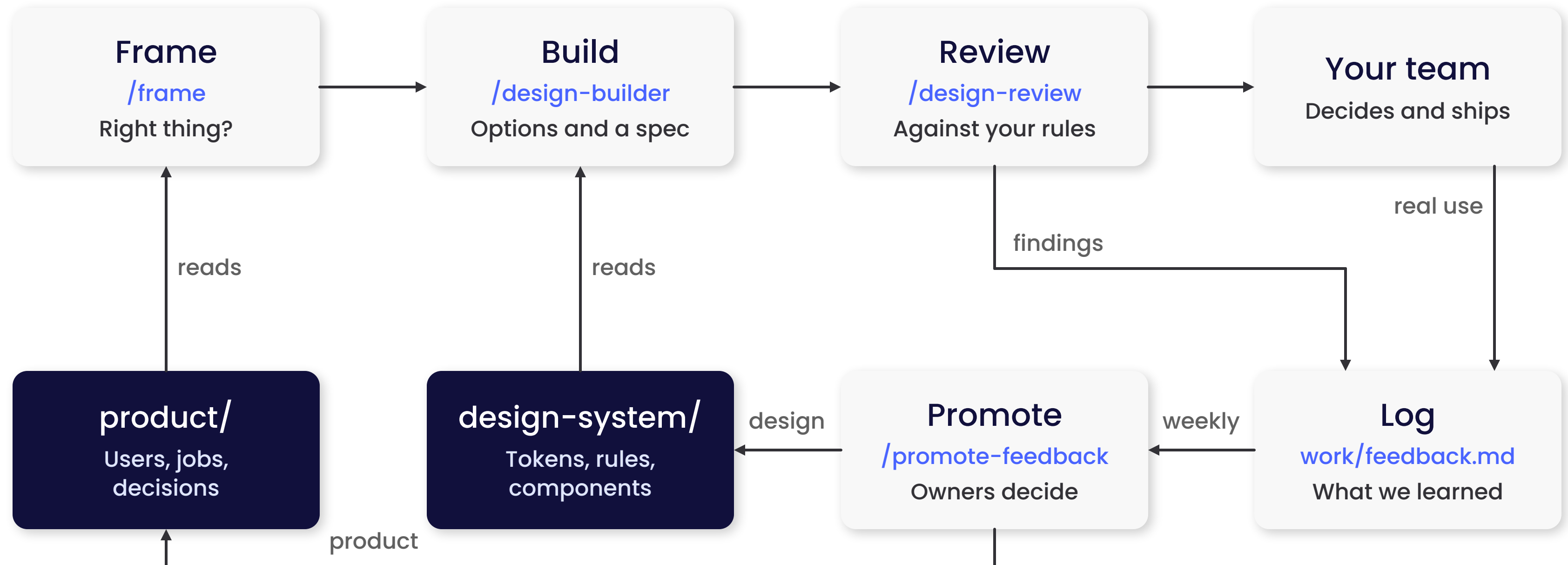
Sorted by priority, then longest waiting. Select several to assign them at once.

Search subject or customer

☐	Request	Status	Assignee	Received
☐	High 3			
☐	Bookings stopped syncing overnight Rafael Duarte · Copperleaf Hotels	In progress	DO Daniel Okafor	Oct 7, 2026, 8:05 AM
☐	Charged twice for the October invoice Amara Osei · Pinecrest Dental	New	Assign	Oct 7, 2026, 9:18 AM

HOW IT FLOWS

From idea to what you learned



IDEA 1

Check the problem first

Before any design, /frame reads the PRD against product/: who it's for, which job, which decisions and constraints. Only a go reaches design.

go	decide first	stop
Support inbox For agents (U-01) who need to start with what's urgent (J-01). <code>examples/prd/support-inbox.md</code>	Hand-off flow Four screens, but no job covers its main goal yet. <code>examples/prd/hand-off.md</code>	Community forum Customer log-ins go against PD-01. Public posts break CON-02. <code>examples/prd/community-forum.md</code>

Every user and job in product/ is marked fact, hypothesis or open, so a PRD built on a guess gets caught.

IDEA 2

One question, one file

Each folder's INDEX.md says which file answers what, and what to read for each task.

product/ — what to build and why

Who uses the product? users.md
What are they trying to get done? jobs.md
What do we call things? concepts.md
What limits us? constraints.md
What do we stand for? principles.md
What have we decided? decisions.md

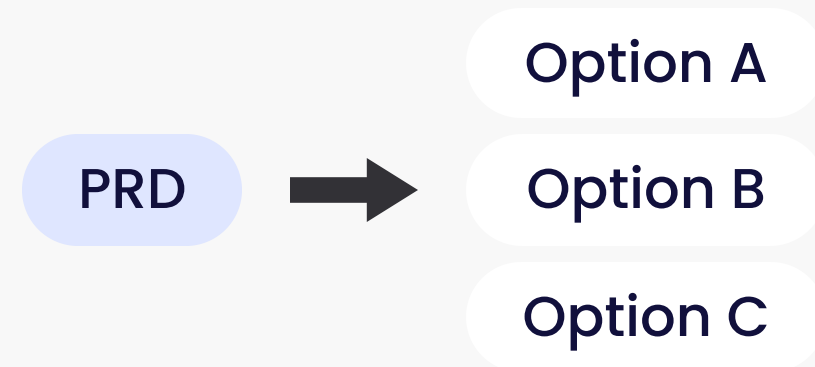
design-system/ — how it looks and works

Which exact values do we use? tokens/
What do we prioritize? principles.md
What must we never do? rules.md
How do we write UI text? writing.md
Which component should I use? components/
How do screens and flows fit? patterns/

IDEA 3

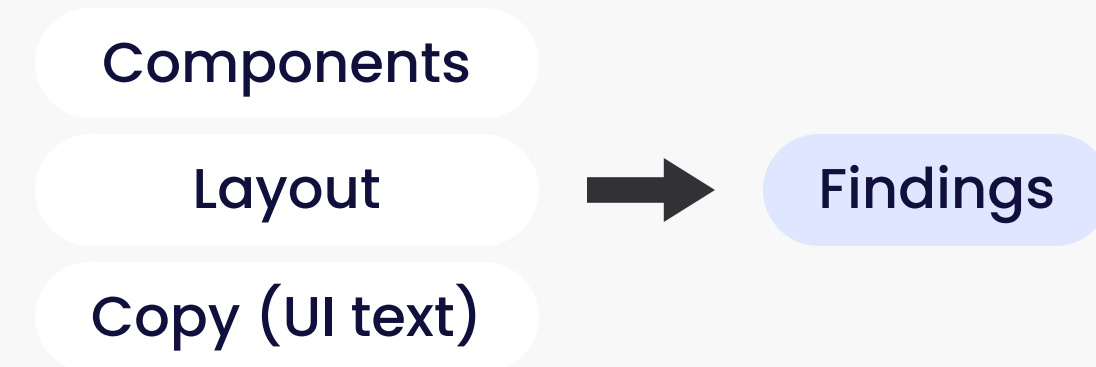
Build wide, review narrow

Build: explore options



Reads only what the framing points to, then builds options that differ in structure, for one screen or a whole flow.

Review: one area at a time

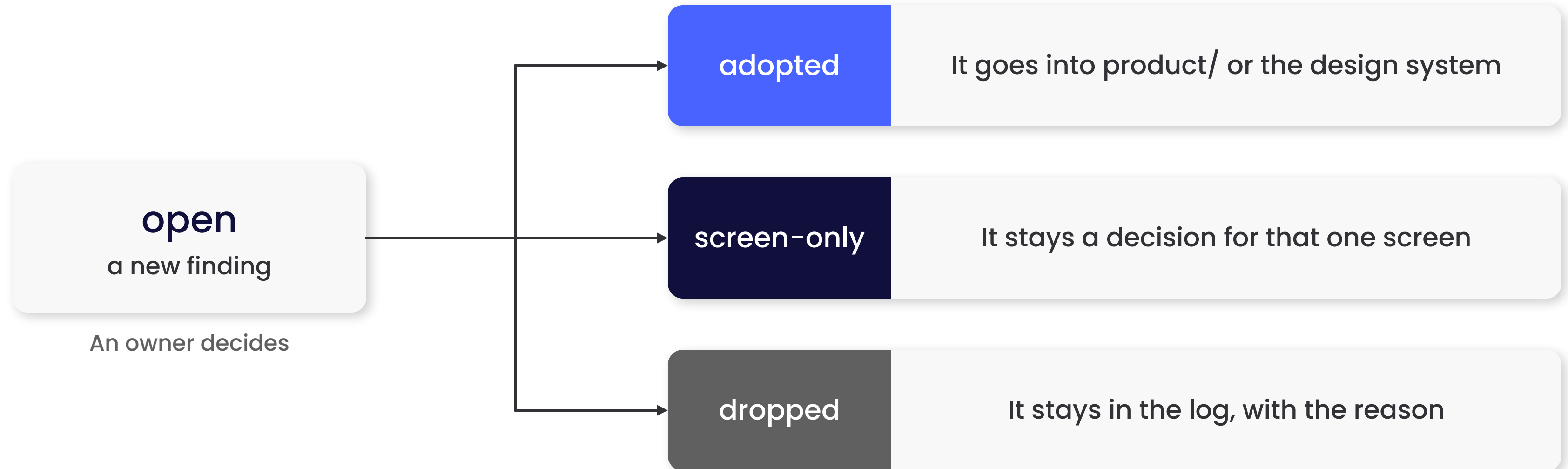


First: does it do the job? Then one area at a time.
Findings cite a rule, or say it's taste.

IDEA 4

Feed what you learn back

Review findings and what real use shows go into one log, marked product (we built the wrong thing) or design (we built it the wrong way).



Running it as a team

Owners are the people in CODEOWNERS: product owners for product/, design owners for design-system/.

First months

Only owners change product/ and the design system. Collect findings first.

Then

Designers open PRs too. Start with UI text rules (writing.md).

Every week

An owner runs promote-feedback and decides.

Approvals

With two or more owners, require their approval on GitHub.

NOT FOR

Screens unlike anything your product has today. The agent drafts options; someone with design experience should finish them.

START

Your first hour

For whoever sets it up. You need Claude Code or Codex, Node 20 or later, and git.

- 1 Use the repo as a template, or copy it into your product repo
- 2 Run `/bootstrap` on your product, with or without a design system
- 3 Check its drafts: users, jobs and your colors
- 4 Write a short PRD for one screen
- 5 Run `/design-builder` with it, then open the proposal

What's inside	
product/	What to build and why
design-system/	How it looks and works
work/	Framings and proposals
.claude/skills/	The five skills
scripts/	check and sync

NEXT

Let's try it on one screen

The screen	The repo	The owner	Questions
[Screen to try]	[URL]	[Name]	[Channel]

[Name] writes a short PRD and runs `/design-builder`, which frames it first. Then we look at the framing and the proposal together. Anything that could apply elsewhere goes into the log.

design-builder, step by step

01

Frame it

Runs /frame if there's no framing yet

02

Define the problem

Whose job (U-, J-) gets better, and how

03

Ask you

Only what changes the design (max 5)

04

Research

Approved screens first, then others

05

Explore

About three clickable mockups, for a screen or a flow

06

Recommend

Pick one, tie it to a principle

07

Write up

Everything on one HTML page

08

Review

Run design-review, then share it with you

Reading by task

• always · ○ when relevant · design-system/INDEX.md. product/INDEX.md has its own: frame reads all of it.

File	Build	Components	Layout	Copy	Promote
components/inventory.md	○	●			
tokens/tokens.css	●	●	○		
tokens/tokens.json					○
foundations/principles.md	●	●	●	○	●
foundations/rules.md	●	●	●	●	●
foundations/writing.md	●			●	○
components/GUIDE.md	○	●			○
components/<name>.md	○	○			○
patterns/GUIDE.md	●		●		○
screens/README.md	●		○		
decisions.md					●

What the check catches

`npm run check` runs on your machine and on every pull request.

File missing from an INDEX

In product/ or design-system/, or its
Answers line doesn't match

Out of sync

Your code changed since the last
npm run sync

Off-token CSS

Hard-coded colors or unknown CSS
variables (R-01)

Duplicate IDs

Two entries share an ID: U-, J-, PD-,
R-, FB- and the rest

Fact or guess?

A user or job not marked fact,
hypothesis or open

Stale notes

Not reviewed in 90 days